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**Rivian restarting work on
its Georgia factory,
emails show**



Rivian will resume prep work on its planned Georgia factory in August and is still looking to break ground early next year, according to emails TechCrunch obtained through a public records request.

The restarted effort comes months after the Biden administration's Department of Energy approved a \$6.6 billion loan meant to fund construction.

Rivian has invested more than \$80 million in the project as of June 20, 2025, up from \$41 million in July 2024, according to a progress report submitted to the local joint development authority included in the emails. The project has created 46 full-time jobs so far. Rivian will begin installing “deep utilities” in August, with “vertical construction” set to begin in the first quarter of 2026, according to the emails.

The company is also reaching out to existing suppliers to see which ones might want to co-locate near the Georgia factory, the emails show. Rivian also asked the state's economic development department for a list of suppliers already in the region that may be able to help build the R2 SUV and R3 hatchback at the factory when it opens in 2028.

Amid this push to restart the project, Rivian's founder and CEO RJ Scaringe met with the state's governor Brian Kemp at the end of May. The company's corporate affairs director told the

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governor’s office in an email that the meeting was a “top priority” for the company.

Peebles Squire, a spokesperson for Rivian, said the meeting between Scaringe and the governor was a “regular check-in.”

“We discussed our ongoing work in Georgia and gave general project updates as well as discussed ways in which we can continue to have a strong partnership with the state,” he wrote in an email to TechCrunch. The governor’s press secretary did not respond to requests for comment.

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Rivian first announced the Georgia factory shortly after its IPO in late 2021. The company originally planned to start construction in 2022 and have vehicle production up and running by 2024. It promised to invest \$5 billion in the facility, and in May 2022, Rivian lined up \$1.5 billion in state incentives to help make that happen.

The factory quickly [faced](#) local opposition. And the project took a back seat as Rivian worked around supply chain shortages during the ramp-up of its R1T pickup truck and R1S SUV at its original factory in Normal, Illinois.

Rivian ultimately pushed back the timeline for the Georgia project in favor of expanding the Normal factory, for which it nabbed \$827 million in incentives from Illinois. The company announced this delay in 2024 when it showed off the R2 SUV and R3 hatchback for the first time.

In late 2024, Rivian announced it had secured the \$6.6 billion loan from the Department of Energy's Loan Programs Office. Specifically the loan would be coming from the Advanced Technology Vehicles Manufacturing program, which is the same effort that helped Tesla navigate the Great Recession more than a decade ago.

That loan agreement was finalized just a few days before Donald Trump was sworn in for his second term, and by that point the deal had already become a target of some of the people in the new president's orbit. Vivek Ramaswamy, who at one point was supposed to co-lead Elon Musk's Department of Government Efficiency, said he [wanted to look into clawing back the loan](#).

After Trump took office, his administration froze all kinds of spending. Some of those freezes were reversed by lower district courts, while others have remained in place as the Supreme Court has mostly allowed the president to operate more freely.

In February, as the administration was shotgun-blasting these spending freezes across the government, Governor Kemp told a local news station he wasn't sure of the status of the loan.

(Squire, in the email, said Rivian continues to work “with DOE and the administration to bring thousands of quality, good paying jobs back to the United States. Electric vehicles are a global strategic industry, and the U.S. should maintain its leadership role in new technologies.”)

Just a few weeks later into March, the emails show, Rivian began coordinating with the governor’s staff for a face-to-face between Kemp and Scaringe. Originally slated to take place on April 9, the meeting had to be rescheduled because the Rivian CEO had a “personal conflict come up.”

Andrew Capezzuto, the corporate affairs director for Rivian, said the meeting was “a top priority” in an apologetic email about the rescheduling.

As Capezzuto hashed out a new time for Scaringe and Kemp to meet, he was also in regular contact with Georgia’s economic development department (GCED), the emails show.

“[W]e are interested in picking back up on supplier conversations,” he told that team on April 8.

“I believe a while back GDEcD had prepared an overview of existing suppliers within Georgia and the greater South East region. Would it be possible to dust that list off so that we can see what suppliers and parts are already available? We would like to use that list to evaluate the existing supplier base and determine whether we can leverage any existing suppliers. That will then also help us determine which suppliers we’d like to consider locate [sic] in Georgia to support the SSN facility.”

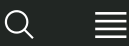
In an email to TechCrunch, Squire said that “Georgia and the Southeast have a very strong automotive supplier base. We want to leverage that

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Sean O'Kane
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Sean O'Kane is a reporter who has spent a decade covering the rapidly-evolving business and technology o...

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Rivian finalizes \$6.6B loan for its Georgia factory

Sean O'Kane — 7:45 AM PST · January 17, 2025

Rivian and the Department of Energy have [finalized](#) a \$6.6 billion loan announced in [November](#) with just a few days left until Donald Trump's inauguration. The company will use the loan to help build out its planned factory in Georgia, east of Atlanta, with construction beginning in 2026. The first R2 SUVs are scheduled to come off the line in 2028.

The loan comes from the Advanced Technology Vehicle Manufacturing (ATVM) program, part of the DOE's Loan Programs Office. ATVM is most well-known as the program that gave Tesla a \$465 million lifeline in 2009.

Rivian's loan drew criticism from Vivek Ramaswamy, who is supposed to be co-leading the so-called "department of government efficiency" with Elon Musk after Trump takes office. Ramaswamy [said](#) he'd look to claw back the loan, though it is unclear how he would try that, and neither he nor Musk have explained exactly how they plan to structure and operate their new effort.

The loan comes in two tranches, which Rivian says it will use to fund the two stages of buildout it's planning in Georgia. Rivian can borrow up to \$3.35 billion in the first tranche, and up to \$2.62 billion in

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the second tranche. (The remaining \$600 million goes toward eliminating interest on the loan.)

Rivian has 52 months to start drawing money from the [agreement](#). It has also made a number of promises to the DOE that it must satisfy to access the funds. The company has to sell at least a certain number of the upcoming R2 SUVs that will be built at its Normal, Illinois factory. (The exact number is redacted in the loan agreement.) It also has to hit certain product design milestones on the R2 and R3 hatchback.

Rivian announced plans for the Georgia factory in December 2021, just a few weeks after the company’s blockbuster IPO. It originally claimed that it would start production at the yet-to-be-built facility in 2024. But last year, in a bid to cut costs, Rivian paused construction on the factory and decided to build the R2 in Illinois instead. Armed with the DOE loan, Rivian now believes it can roll new vehicles off the line at the plant four years later than originally planned.

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Sean O'Kane

Sr. Reporter, Transportation |

Sean O’Kane is a reporter who has spent a decade covering the rapidly-evolving business and technology o...

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Rivian wraps 2024 with more than 50,000 EVs delivered

Sean O'Kane — 6:16 AM PST · January 3, 2025

Rivian finished last year having delivered 51,579 electric SUVs, trucks, and vans, more than triple the number it shipped to customers in 2023.

The company [announced](#) Friday that it also built 49,476 EVs in 2024. That's about 8,000 fewer than it expected to manufacture as recently as July. Rivian was forced to lower its expectations, though, when it ran into [a component shortage](#) that dragged down production. That shortage is resolved, according to the press release.

Rivian won't release its financial results for the year until February 20, but the delivery and production

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figures help wrap what was an up-and-down year for the growing EV company.

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The company began 2024 by [cutting 10% of its workforce](#) in February, as it and others were locked in a pricing war set off by Tesla.

One month later, Rivian [revealed](#) the R2 SUV, its upcoming midsize SUV that is supposed to sell in much higher numbers than the current R1S. The R2 is slated to start around \$45,000 and will be built at the company's factory in Normal, Illinois.

The R2 announcement event came with its own mixed bag of news. Rivian rolled out a genuine surprise that was [a huge hit](#): the R3 hatchback, which is supposed to enter production after the R2. But the company also announced it was delaying its new factory in Georgia, and said it would expand the Normal factory in the meantime.

In May, Rivian started rolling out [revamped versions](#) of the R1S and the R1T pickup truck. The company simplified the inner workings of the vehicles in a bid to staunch its [perpetual and supersized financial losses](#).

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The company got another boost in June when it announced a joint venture with Volkswagen Group. The German giant pledged to invest \$5 billion into the collaboration, while Rivian agreed to provide software and electrical architecture know-how that will help modernize Volkswagen's portfolio. (The deal officially closed in November and [grew to \\$5.8 billion](#).)

Rivian finished the year by [securing a \\$6.6 billion loan commitment](#) from the Biden administration to help build the Georgia factory — although that loan is already in the crosshairs of some of the incoming Trump administration's top advisers.

This year could be just as chaotic for Rivian. Not only could the \$6.6 billion loan become a political minefield, but Rivian — and other EV makers — are staring down the real possibility that the Trump administration will try to find a way to do away with the \$7,500 federal tax credit for electric vehicles. That could put even more pressure on Rivian as it

fights to get the R2 into production in the first half of 2026.

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